

Emergency Contacts

RUIZ

URGENT REPAIRS

**For urgent property issues that occur outside of business hours (Monday to Friday, 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM excluding public holidays), please follow the guidance below to ensure timely and effective support.*

What is an urgent repair?

- a burst water service
- a blocked or broken lavatory system
- a serious roof leak
- a gas leak
- a dangerous electrical fault
- flooding or serious flood damage
- serious storm or fire damage
- a failure of gas, electricity or water supply to the property
- a failure of any refrigerator or laundry appliance supplied with the property, or any service for hot water, cooking, heating or cooling
- any fault or damage that makes the property unsafe or insecure, or is likely to cause injury to person or property, or
- a serious fault in any door, staircase, lift or other common area that prevents (or causes undue inconvenience to) the tenant accessing or using the property.

If any of the above issues occur and your property is within a unit plan, please contact your strata management's after-hours service. For all other situations, refer to the after-hours contractors listed below

Plumbing:

- Level Plumbing: (02) 6189 2414

Electrical:

- Level Electrical Hume: (02) 6109 5049

Locksmith:

- ASI Locksmith: (02) 6171 4000
- Class Locksmiths: (02) 6280 6611

**Payment to a locksmith should a lockout situation occur where tenants lose, misplace or have keys stolen and any associated key replacements.*

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Arrears Management



In the Australian Capital Territory (ACT), property management agencies are governed by specific legislation when it comes to managing rental arrears. Here's a breakdown of how RUIZ will handle rental arrears based on ACT legislation:

1. **Initial Communication:** When a tenant falls behind on rent, RUIZ will typically start by contacting the tenant to remind them of their obligations. This communication can be via phone, email, or written notice.
2. **Notice of Breach:** If the rent remains unpaid after the initial reminder, the agency will issue a formal Notice to Remedy Breach according to the *Residential Tenancies Act 1997* (ACT). This notice informs the tenant of the overdue rent and provides a specified period (usually 7 days) to pay the arrears or face further action.
3. **Follow-up Communication:** During the specified period given in the Notice to Remedy Breach, RUIZ may continue to communicate with the tenant to encourage payment. They may offer assistance or discuss possible payment arrangements if necessary.
4. **Termination Notice:** If the tenant fails to pay the overdue rent within the specified period in the Notice to Remedy Breach, RUIZ may issue a Termination Notice according to the *Residential Tenancies Act 1997* (ACT). This notice terminates the tenancy agreement and provides the tenant with a specified period (usually 14 days) to vacate the property or dispute the termination.
5. **Application to ACAT:** If the tenant disputes the termination, they may apply to the ACT Civil and Administrative Tribunal (ACAT) to resolve the matter. RUIZ would need to attend the hearing and present evidence of the tenant's rental arrears and breach of the tenancy agreement.
6. **Possession Order:** If ACAT rules in favour of RUIZ, they may issue a Possession Order, allowing the agency to take possession of the property. The tenant will then be required to vacate the premises.

It's important for property management agencies to follow the procedures outlined in the *Residential Tenancies Act 1997* (ACT) to ensure compliance with the law and protect the rights of both landlords and tenants. Additionally, RUIZ will keep detailed records of all communications and actions taken regarding rental arrears for documentation purposes.

Tenant Information



By following this checklist, you can ensure a smooth transition into your new rental property and address any issues or concerns promptly.

1. **Inspect the property:** Please conduct a thorough inspection of the property to ensure everything is in good condition and matches the condition report provided by the Property Manager, this has been emailed to all tenants listed on the lease. The ingoing condition report must be signed and returned to our office within 14 days of the lease start date to be warranted on exit inspection.
2. **Check Utilities:** It is the tenant's responsibility to arrange and connect essential services such as electricity, gas, and internet (if required) upon moving into the property. Be sure to check availability and complete the necessary setup prior to or immediately after moving in.
3. **Review Arrears Management:** Read through the arrears document provided carefully to understand our responsibility around rent payment schedules and procedures.
4. **Maintenance requests:** Please submit all maintenance requests in writing by an email with a short description and photos. This streamlines the communication process and ensures that requests are documented and addressed promptly.
5. **Emergency Maintenance:** Please refer to your Urgent Repair list in your tenant pack for contact information.
6. **Noise in residential areas :** Please refer to accesscanberra.act.gov.au for specific information. The ACT noise limits or standards are detailed in relevant regulations.

Managing And Reducing Mould

RUIZ

Canberra's climate, characterised by cold winters and humid summers, creates an environment conducive to mould growth. As tenants, it is crucial to implement proactive measures to manage and reduce mould effectively. This document outlines practical strategies to combat mould in Canberra properties.

Understanding Mould: Mould thrives in damp and poorly ventilated areas, such as bathrooms, kitchens, basements, and areas affected by water leaks. It not only compromises indoor air quality but also causes structural damage and triggers respiratory problems. Common types of mould found in Canberra properties include Aspergillus, Penicillium, and Stachybotrys (black mould).

It is the tenant's responsibility to mitigate potential long-term damage by minimising condensation

Preventive Measures:

1. Adequate Ventilation: Ensure proper ventilation in bathrooms, kitchens, and laundry rooms by installing exhaust fans and keeping windows open when possible.
2. Moisture Control: Regularly inspect the property for leaks, condensation, and water ingress if you see mould. Promptly contact your Property Manager.
3. Heating and Insulation: Maintain a consistent temperature within the property to prevent condensation.
4. Proper Sealing: If you see unsealed gaps and cracks in windows, doors, and walls causing moisture intrusion please advise your Property Manager.
5. Regular Cleaning: We encourage tenants to clean and dry surfaces prone to moisture accumulation, such as bathroom tiles, shower curtains, and windowsills, to inhibit mould growth.
6. Outdoor Maintenance: Keep gutters clean and ensure proper drainage away from the property's foundation to prevent water pooling.